

Publish Your First Paid Mobile App

Describe it. Build it with AI. Ship it to the App Store, Google Play & Samsung - and get paid. A step-by-step 60-day guide, no code experience required.

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replit agent - your app, built by AI

$ describe your app in plain English
> build me an app that tracks tax deadlines for freelancers
  scaffolding iPhone + Android app ..... done
  wiring RevenueCat subscriptions ..... done
  preview ready -> scan the QR, it runs on your phone
$ 60 days later: live on 3 app stores, earning
```

\$124

joins all 3 app stores

60 days

idea to launch

3

fill-in worksheets

START HERE

You're closer than you think

Sixty days from now your app can be live on three app stores with a working paywall. Not a prototype - a real product that strangers can find, install, and pay for. The code is no longer the barrier: AI agents write it while you describe what you want. What actually stops people is the process around the code, and that's exactly what this handbook hands you: every step, in order, with the traps flagged before you hit them.

Work through it in order. Each part tells you how long it takes, what you'll walk away with, and ends with one **DO THIS NOW** action - do them as you read and by the last page you won't be planning an app, you'll be shipping one.

Part 1	Why now - the 10-minute business case
Part 2	Choose & design an app small enough to win
Part 3	Build it with AI - the Replit walkthrough
Part 4	Register with all three stores (\$124 total)
Part 5	Turn on the money - subscriptions without billing code
Part 6	The 60-day schedule + launch & grow
Worksheet A	The pre-submission launch checklist
Worksheet B	12-tester recruitment scripts
Worksheet C	Store listing template

The 10-minute business case

Time: 10 minutes · You walk away with: certainty that this is worth your next 60 days

Publishing an app used to mean months of native development in two programming languages. In 2026 one plain-English description becomes a working iPhone + Android app, and payment infrastructure comes pre-built. The gatekeeping fees are gone too - **\$124 covers all three stores**: \$99/year for Apple, \$25 once for Google, and Samsung is free.

The math that should excite you

A \$4.99/month subscription needs just **170 subscribers to clear \$10K a year**. You don't need a viral hit - you need a niche you already understand and a paywall in the right place. Niche apps are cheaper to market, convert better, and rank easier in store search than general ones. Your unfair advantage is whatever audience you already serve.

What actually filters people out

Not talent. Not code. It's the invisible process: identity checks that take days, review guidelines that reject half of first submissions, and a Google Play testing rule that silently adds two weeks. Every one of those is handled in the pages ahead - once you can see the traps, none of them can stop you.

> **DO THIS NOW:** (5 min) Write your app in one sentence: 'An app that ____ for ____.' Send it to three people in that niche and ask: 'Would you pay \$5/month for this?' Two yeses = green light. You now have a validated idea before most people finish overthinking.

Design an app small enough to win

Time: 2-3 evenings · You walk away with: a locked idea, a sketch, and your store listing drafted

- 01 Lock one problem for one audience.** If the pitch needs a paragraph, the app is too big. 'Tax deadline tracker for freelancers' ships; 'personal finance app' dies in development. Small is not a compromise - small is the strategy.
- 02 Sketch the daily loop - three screens, max.** What does a user see the moment they open it? What's the one action they repeat daily? What shows their progress? Draw those three on paper. Everything else waits until after launch.
- 03 Draft the store listing before the app exists.** Icon idea, five screenshot headlines, one-line pitch (Worksheet C walks you through each field). This feels backwards - it's not. The listing is your promise, and building toward a promise keeps the app honest and the scope tiny.
- 04 Place the paywall on paper.** Decide now where free ends: three uses, one project, or seven days. Users accept a paywall they saw coming; they punish one bolted on later with one-star reviews.

Rule of thumb: if version 1 takes more than two weeks of evenings, cut features until it doesn't. Nobody has ever regretted launching too small; every abandoned app died too big.

>_ DO THIS NOW: (20 min) Grab paper, draw your three screens, and mark with an X where the paywall appears. Photograph it. That photo is your spec - you're already ahead of everyone still 'researching'.

The Replit walkthrough, step by step

Time: 1-2 evenings to a working prototype · You walk away with: your app running on your own phone

Replit is the fastest current path from description to installable app: the AI agent writes the code, the live preview runs on your phone, and RevenueCat subscriptions are a built-in integration. You brief it like a designer, not a programmer.

- 01 Create your account.** Sign up at replit.com/refer/yber2001 - signing up through this referral link gives you bonus credits to build with, so the first sessions cost you nothing.
- 02 Start from the money-ready template.** In the template gallery, search '**RevenueCat Mobile Subscription**' (the official Expo + RevenueCat starter) and fork it - the paywall plumbing is already wired. Or simply tell the agent: *'Build me a mobile app that [your one-line pitch from Part 1]'*.
- 03 Iterate in plain English.** Brief it the way you'd brief a designer: 'make the home screen a checklist', 'add a streak counter', 'use a calmer color scheme'. One change per prompt, check the live preview, then ask for the next. Momentum beats perfection - you can polish forever after it works.
- 04 Run it on your real phone in minute one.** Install the free **Expo Go** app, scan the QR code Replit shows, and your app is running in your hand. Purchases show a safe test dialog - no real money moves until you're live in the stores.
- 05 Add the paywall with one prompt.** *'Add RevenueCat subscriptions with a monthly and annual plan, and show the paywall after the free tier ends.'* The agent wires the SDK; you'll connect the store products in Part 5.
- 06 Export and ship.** When the loop works on your phone, follow Replit's App Store guide to produce the store builds, then carry them into Part 4's consoles.

> **DO THIS NOW:** (30 min, tonight) Open replit.com/refer/yber2001, fork the RevenueCat template, and send your first prompt. You will have a running app before you close the laptop - that feeling is the fuel for the next 59 days.

Join all three stores - tonight

Time: about 1 hour of forms · You walk away with: all three registrations submitted and verifying

Identity verification takes days and runs in parallel with your build - which is why this happens the same week you start building, not when the app is 'ready'.

Store	Cost	What to know
Apple App Store	\$99 / year	Enroll at developer.apple.com with an Apple ID (two-factor on). Individual enrollment is fine - no company paperwork. Review takes 24-48h per submission.
Google Play	\$25 once	Sign up at play.google.com/console with government-ID verification. Cheapest ticket, but see the testing rule below before planning your launch date.
Samsung Galaxy Store	Free	Register at seller.samsungapps.com , then request Commercial Seller status (name must exactly match your government ID). Accepts the same Android build you make for Google Play - with far less competition.

The rule that catches first-timers: a personal Google Play account created after Nov 13, 2023 cannot publish publicly until it passes a closed test with **12 testers opted in continuously for 14 days**. Plan those two weeks into your schedule and start recruiting testers the day you start building (Worksheet B has the exact scripts). Samsung has no such rule - a useful first store while the Google clock runs. Organization accounts with a D-U-N-S number are exempt.

>_ DO THIS NOW: (1 hour) Open all three registration pages in tabs right now and submit them tonight. The verification clocks only start when you press submit - every day you wait is a day added to your launch date.

Subscriptions without billing code

Time: 1 evening · You walk away with: a working payroll you've tested end to end

Apple and Google each run their own billing systems with their own receipts and edge cases.

[RevenueCat](#) abstracts both behind one SDK - free until your app earns \$2.5K/month, which is exactly the phase where you shouldn't be writing billing code.

- 01 One project, both stores.** Create a free RevenueCat account and attach your App Store and Play Store app records to a single project.
- 02 Mirror your products.** Create the products in App Store Connect and Play Console (e.g. **monthly_pro** at \$4.99, **annual_pro** at \$39.99), mirror them in RevenueCat, and group them into one 'pro' entitlement your app checks.
- 03 Ship a templated payroll.** Use RevenueCat's proven layouts instead of designing from scratch. Rehearse the full flow in test mode: purchase, restore, cancel. Real billing switches on automatically when your store listing goes live.

Pricing that works for first apps

Anchor annual at roughly 7x monthly (\$4.99 / \$39.99) so the yearly plan reads as the obvious deal. Start slightly higher than feels comfortable - lowering a price later delights users; raising one annoys them. Add a 3-7 day free trial once reviews are positive, not before.

>_ DO THIS NOW: (15 min) Create the RevenueCat account and name your two products now, while your store registrations verify. When the consoles open up, you'll connect three dots instead of starting from zero.

Your 60-day countdown

Time: 8 weeks, mostly evenings · You walk away with: a live, paid app on up to three stores

Week	Milestone
1	Lock the idea (Part 1-2). Register all three stores (Part 4). Start posting your build in public.
2-3	Build the MVP on Replit (Part 3). Draft icon and screenshots alongside the code, not after it.
4	Wire the paywall (Part 5), test sandbox purchases, put a beta build in friends' hands (TestFlight on iOS).
5-6	Google Play closed test running (12 testers x 14 days - Worksheet B). Iterate on their feedback while the clock runs.
7	Submit to App Store review and Samsung. Fix rejections fast - broken links, missing demo accounts, and vague descriptions are the usual culprits (Worksheet A catches all three).
8	Public release everywhere. Announce to the audience you built along the way - they're your first reviews and first customers.

After launch: the compounding loop

- **Build in public from week one.** Daily progress posts on Threads or X become your 12 beta testers, your first reviews, and your first customers - free marketing that must start before launch, not after.
- **Stack revenue streams.** Pair the app with digital products - templates, checklists, guides on Gumroad - so your audience has something to buy at every price point.
- **Time launches for upside.** Annual hackathons (RevenueCat's Shipaton is the biggest) pay cash prizes just for shipping during their window - free money if your timeline lines up.
- **Iterate on reviews.** Your first 100 users tell you exactly what v2 is. Ship monthly; both stores reward active apps with better ranking.

> **_ DO THIS NOW:** (2 min) Put 'Week 1' in your calendar - a real date, this week. The 60-day clock only exists once it starts. Then turn the page and run Worksheet A before every submission.

Tick every box before you submit

Accounts & legal

- ☐ Apple Developer Program active (\$99/yr) - two-factor enabled
- ☐ Google Play Console verified (\$25) - ID check passed
- ☐ Samsung Seller Portal - Commercial Seller status approved
- ☐ Privacy policy URL live (required by all three stores)
- ☐ Support email / page live and monitored

Product

- ☐ Core daily loop works offline / on poor network
- ☐ Paywall tested in sandbox: purchase, restore, cancel
- ☐ No placeholder text, dead buttons, or broken links anywhere
- ☐ Demo account created for reviewers (note it in review notes)
- ☐ Crash-free session rate above 99% in your beta

Listing

- ☐ App icon final at all required sizes
- ☐ 5 screenshots per platform - first one carries the pitch
- ☐ Title + subtitle include your main search keyword
- ☐ Description first line sells the outcome, not the features
- ☐ Age rating questionnaire completed honestly
- ☐ Privacy 'nutrition label' filled (Apple) / Data safety form (Google)

Distribution

- ☐ 12 Google Play testers recruited and opted in (14-day clock started)
- ☐ TestFlight beta shipped to at least 5 people
- ☐ Launch announcement drafted for your social audience

Fill your Google Play closed test in 48 hours

You need 12 people opted in continuously for 14 days. Recruit 16-18 so dropouts don't reset your clock. Three scripts, escalating from warm to cold:

Script 1 - Direct message to friends & family

Hey! I built a mobile app and Google requires 12 beta testers for 2 weeks before I can launch. All you do is install it from a link and open it now and then. Can I count you in? Takes 1 minute to set up - I'll send the link.

Script 2 - Social post (Threads / X / LinkedIn)

I need 12 beta testers for my new app [ONE-LINE PITCH]. Google Play requires a 14-day closed test before launch. Early access + your name in the credits + you shape v1. Reply with a wave emoji and I'll DM you the link. First 15 people are in.

Script 3 - Communities (Reddit, Discord, forums)

[Beta] Looking for Android testers for [APP NAME] - [ONE-LINE PITCH]. It's free for testers, feedback genuinely shapes the roadmap, and I'll share launch numbers back with this community. Comment or DM for the opt-in link. (Mods: happy to remove if not allowed.)

Keep testers opted in: the 14 days must be continuous. Message the group on day 3, 7, and 11 with a changelog ('fixed the crash you found') - engaged testers don't uninstall, and their feedback doubles as your first reviews.

Fill in the blanks, paste into the consoles

Field	Formula + your answer
App name 30 chars	[Brand] - [main keyword] _____
Subtitle / short desc. 30-80 chars	[Outcome] for [audience] _____
First description line	The one sentence a skimmer reads: outcome, not features. _____
Screenshot 1	Your pitch as a headline over the best screen. If they only see one image, this is it. _____
Screenshots 2-5	One benefit each, in the order of your daily loop. _____
Keywords Apple: 100 chars	Niche terms beat big ones: 'freelancer tax tracker' ranks; 'finance' never will. _____
Review notes	Demo login + one paragraph explaining what the app does. Reviewers reject what they can't understand in 60 seconds. _____

You have everything now - the process, the schedule, and the worksheets. The only remaining variable is the start date. Questions, updates, and more tools for independent builders: selamcpa.com. Fees and store policies change - verify current terms in each console. © 2026 Selam CPA. For personal use; please don't redistribute.